Asia Pacific Aviation Nowcast

Nowcast #144: Lackluster China Golden Week

Industry Overview

09 October 2026

Equity
Asia-Pacific
Airlines

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Real time tracking of Asian travel trends

Our 144th Nowcast shows high frequency travel trends across Asia. China Golden Week holiday travel was a bit lacklustre with air traffic flattish YoY and ticket prices up +9.5% YoY (below pre-sale levels). Indian air traffic declines moderated in September 2026, and all eyes are on the size of capacity restoration during the peak months with fuel staying very high. Taiwanese airlines saw August yields up low single digit YoY, while Korean Air international traffic growth slowed a little on a shorter Chuseok holiday this year.

China: Muted volume/pricing for October Golden Week

China domestic September ex fuel surcharge pricing recovered to +0.5% YoY while load factors were flattish YoY. The first three days of October Golden Week underwhelmed (see: our read on first 4-day data) but both price and volumes recovered in the second half of the holiday period. For the October Golden Week, overall air traffic was flattish YoY and up low single digit YoY including the week ahead of the holiday. October Golden Week pricing recovered to +9.5% YoY (estimated ex-fuel price +4% YoY) which was a bit underwhelming relative to holiday pre-sale price growth of +11.2% YoY.

India: Traffic declines moderate in September 2026

Indian domestic air traffic was -5% YoY in September 2026 showing some directional improvement relative to August 2026 domestic traffic at -7% YoY. Indian international air traffic was -2% YoY in September 2026 showing some improvement from -6% YoY in August 2026. Airline data shows both IndiGo and Air India continued to cut capacity in August 2026 to factor the impact of elevated jet fuel.

Taiwan, HK & SG: Low double digit passenger yields in TW

Taiwan August passenger yields grew +11% YoY showing solid pricing power through the peak and September revenue data suggest similar yield trends continuing in September. Cathay Pacific and Singapore Airlines load factors have moderated in recent months showing the best of the Gulf traffic diversions has passed and with Singapore Airlines adding additional flights on Europe and Australia/NZ.

Korea & Japan: Korean growth slows on shorter holiday

Korean international passenger traffic was +10% YoY in September with Korean Air's intenational traffic +5% YoY showing some growth decleration given the slightly shorter Chuseok holiday in 2026. Japanese domestic air travel in August was disrupted by typhoon weather and we're watching for weather impacts again in September 2026.

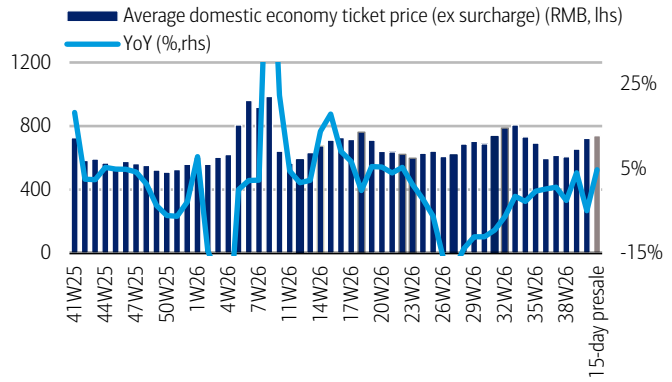
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Chinese air travel trends – Sep

Ex-surcharge ticket price 0.5% YoY, flights 2.1% YoY

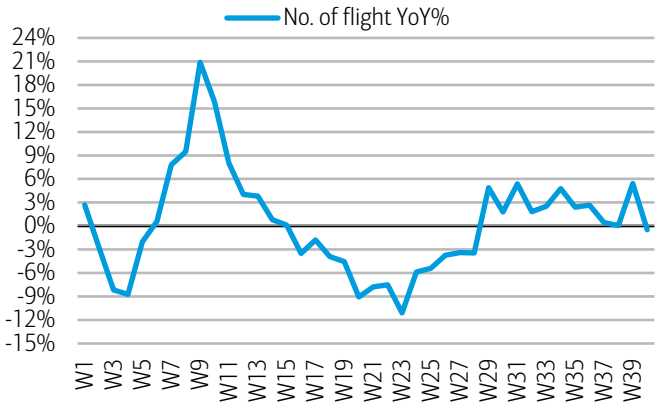
Exhibit 1: The average ex-fuel surcharge ticket price was largely flattish YoY in Sep
China domestic ex-tax economy ticket price in RMB, YoY%



Source: DAST, BofA Global Research

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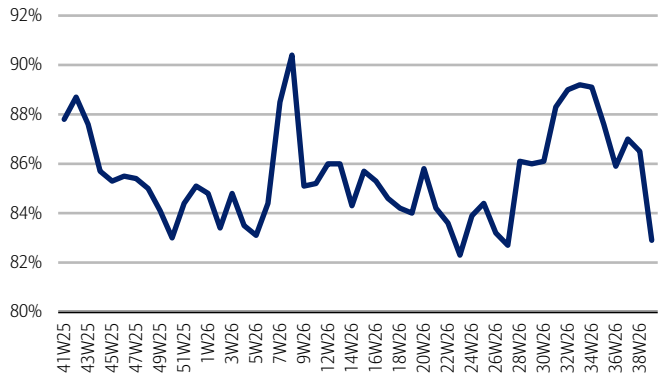
Exhibit 2: Sep no. of flight was 2.1% YoY
China weekly total number of flight YoY%



Source: DAST, BofA Global Research

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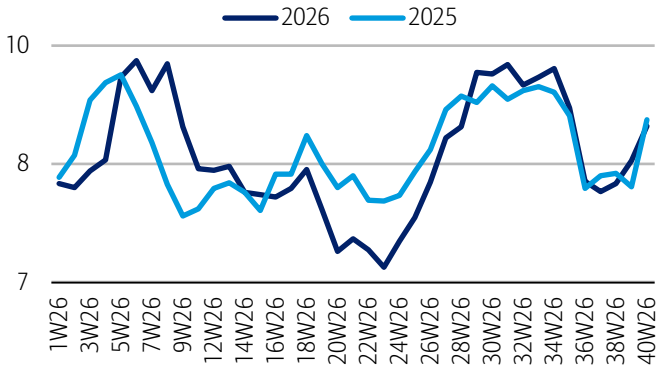
Exhibit 3: The load factor dived post Summer peak
China weekly overall load factor



Source: DAST, BofA Global Research

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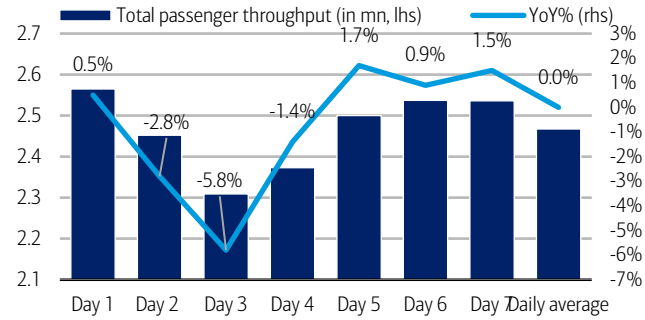
Exhibit 4: The fleet utilization sharply decreased post Summer peak
The overall fleet utilization (in hours) in 2025-2026



Source: DAST, BofA Global Research

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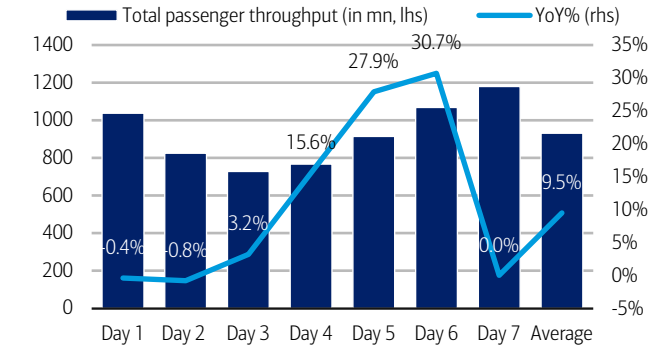
Exhibit 5: The passenger throughput by air was flattish YoY in Golden Week
2026 Day 1-7 and daily average Oct Golden Week total passenger by air throughput and YoY



Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 6: The full price achieved 9.5% YoY in 7-day holiday
The domestic full (including fuel-surcharge) average economy class price in Oct Golden Week

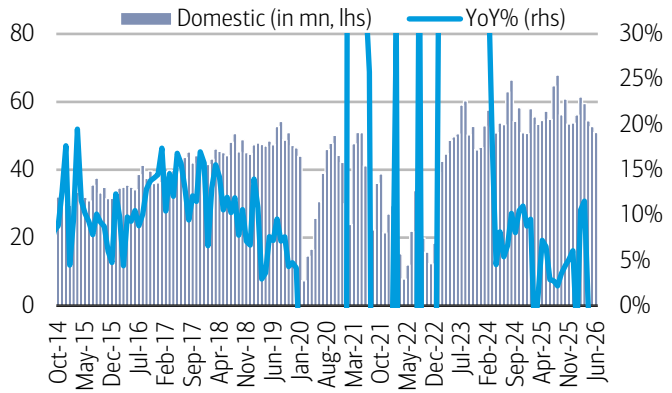


Source: DAST, BofA Global Research

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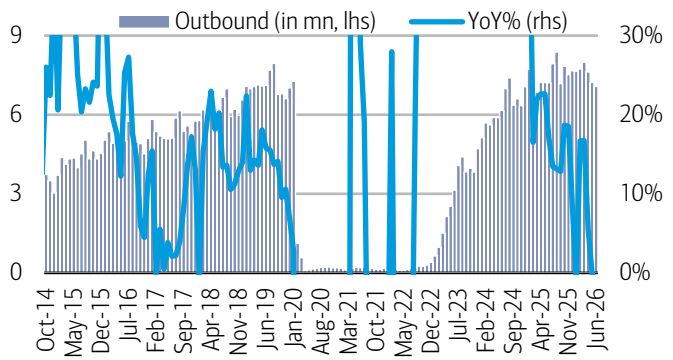
Exhibit 7: China domestic passenger carried was 5% YoY in Aug'26
China monthly domestic air passenger carried (in mn) and YoY% from 2014-2026



Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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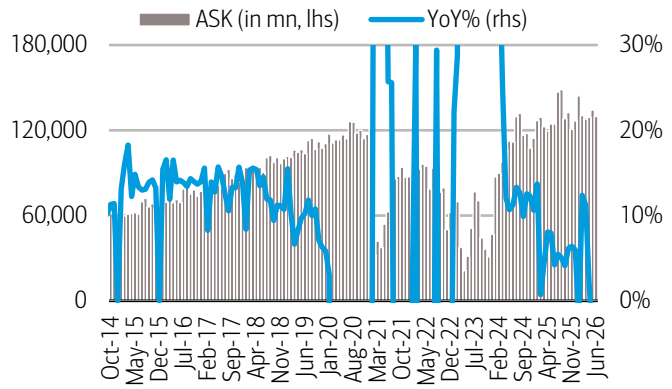
Exhibit 8: China outbound passenger carried growth at 2% YoY in Aug'26
China monthly outbound air passenger carried (in mn) and YoY% from 2014-2026



Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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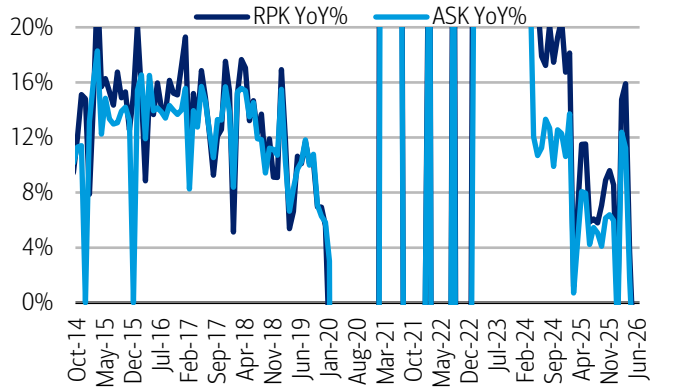
Exhibit 9: Industry ASK was at 4.8% YoY, 130% of 2019 in Aug'26
Chinese airlines monthly ASK (in mn) and YoY% from 2014-2026



Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 10: RPK growth at 6.4% YoY in Aug'26
China PRK and ASK YoY% from 2014-2026

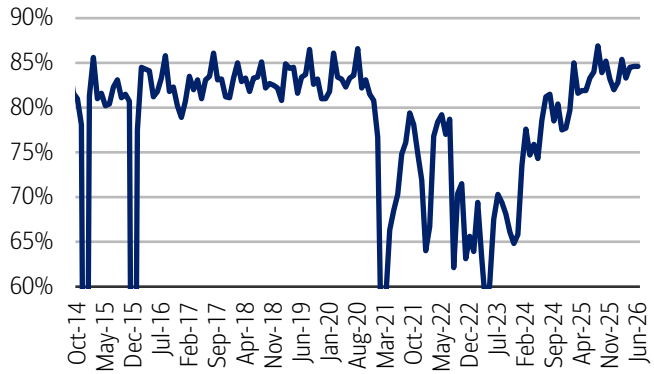


Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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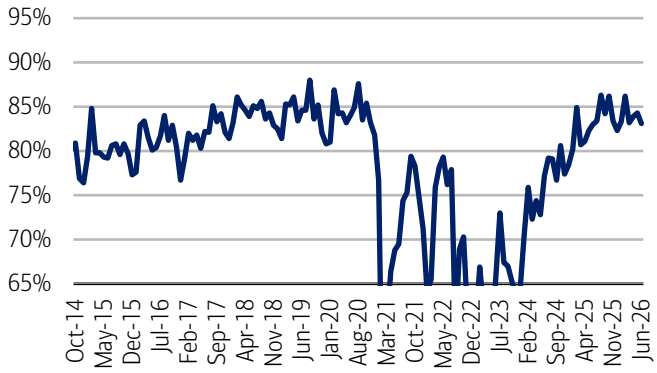
Exhibit 11: Load factor reached 88.8%, 1.3pp/2.2p v.s 2025/2019 in Aug'26
Chinese airlines overall monthly load factor from 2014-2026



Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 12: Chinese domestic load factor at 85.7%, 0.2pp/-1.9pp versus 2025/2019 in Aug'26
Chinese airlines domestic monthly load factor from 2014-2026

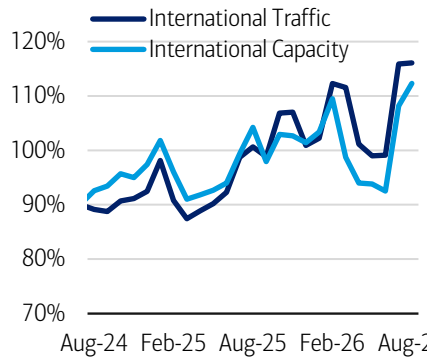


Source: MoT, BofA Global Research

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International – Traffic

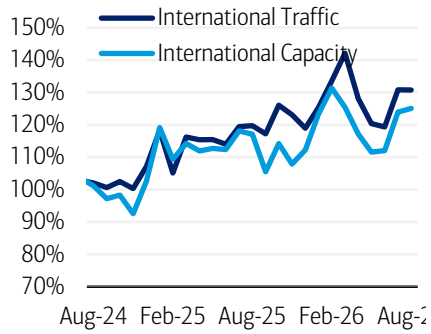
Exhibit 13: Air China international traffic and capacity as % of 2019 levels, 2024-2026
Traffic at 116% of 2019 in Aug



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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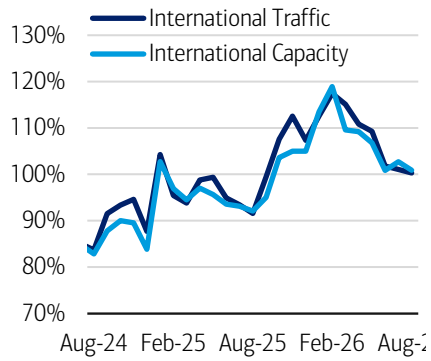
Exhibit 14: China Eastern – international traffic and capacity as % of 2019 levels, 2024-2026
Traffic at 131% of 2019 in Aug



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 15: China Southern – international traffic & capacity as % of 2019, 2024-2026
Traffic at 100% of 2019 in Aug



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 16: China short-haul outbound by seats (% YoY), 2026
Southeast Asia and Korea gained most capacity growth in summer

	Thailand	Japan	Singapore	Malaysia	HK	Korea	Indonesia	Vietnam	Taiwan	Cambodia	Philippines
Jul-26	14%	-53%	8%	42%	5%	5%	21%	13%	5%	18%	26%
Aug-26	17%	-52%	9%	40%	3%	7%	13%	12%	5%	23%	22%
Sep-26	28%	-45%	13%	43%	5%	11%	6%	22%	3%	9%	22%
Oct-26	12%	-43%	5%	30%	5%	6%	-1%	11%	2%	11%	17%
Nov-26	3%	-27%	-9%	17%	1%	0%	-5%	-13%	-2%	-6%	16%
Dec-26	-9%	-1%	-17%	8%	-1%	5%	-6%	-18%	-1%	1%	10%

Source: Diio, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 17: China long-haul outbound by seat (% YoY), 2026
Australia, Canada, Russia and New Zealand had most capacity growth in 2H 2026

	USA	Australia	UK	Germany	Russia	UAE	France	Canada	Netherlands	NZ
Jul-26	-2%	32%	9%	6%	30%	15%	2%	45%	-4%	32%
Aug-26	-1%	37%	5%	6%	33%	6%	1%	38%	-3%	21%
Sep-26	-1%	38%	13%	7%	36%	6%	4%	24%	-6%	27%
Oct-26	3%	33%	8%	5%	25%	7%	3%	20%	-3%	25%
Nov-26	2%	22%	6%	4%	14%	5%	0%	19%	12%	8%
Dec-26	1%	-6%	-8%	15%	12%	8%	4%	19%	3%	-21%

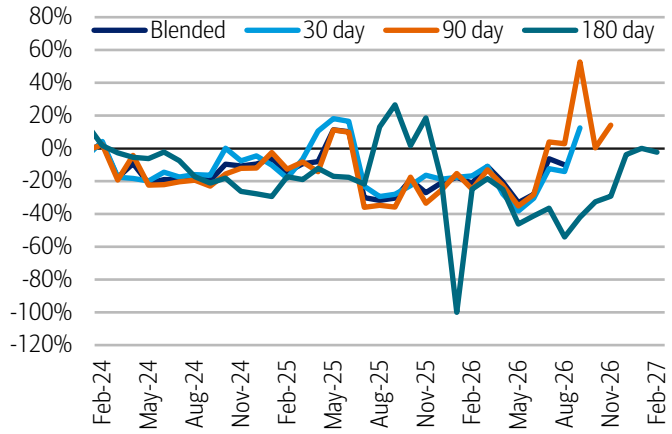
Source: Diio, BofA Global Research

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APAC airfare check-in

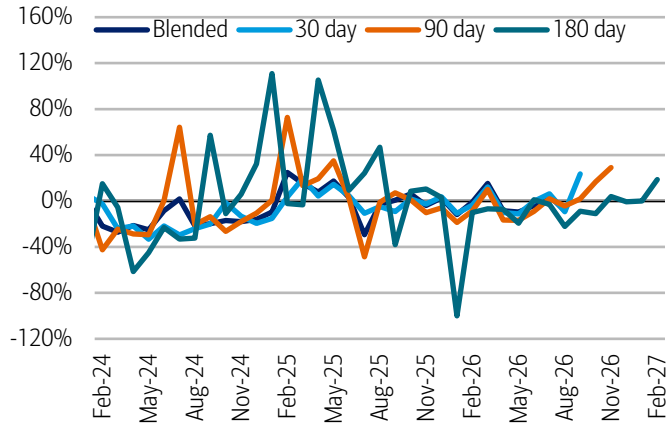
Exhibit 18: ANA yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Early booking airfares YoY declining airfares into September 2026



Source: RDC

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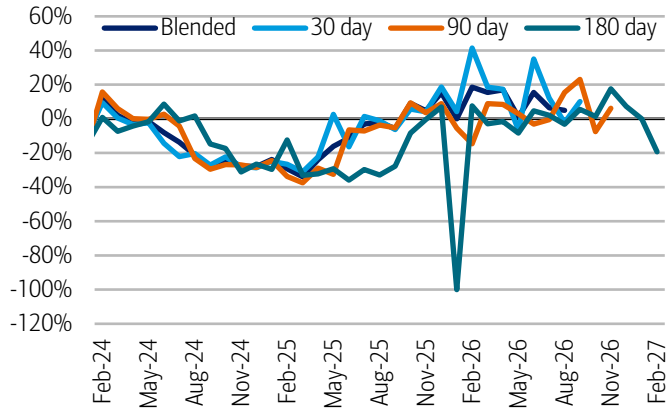
Exhibit 19: JAL yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Early booking airfares suggest YoY negative trends into coming quarters



Source: RDC

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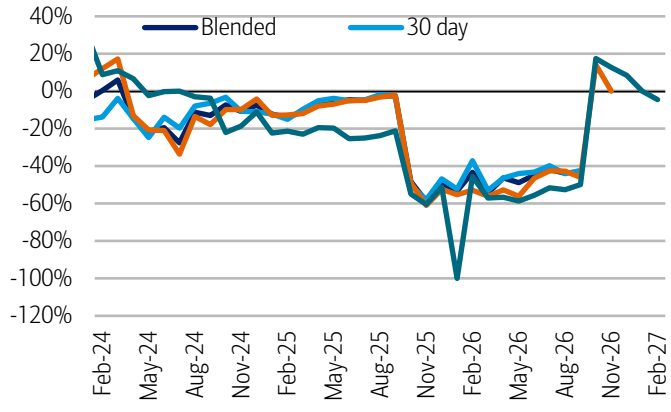
Exhibit 20: China Airlines yields (% YoY), 2024-27
Yields expected to remain under YoY pressure through summer 2026



Source: RDC

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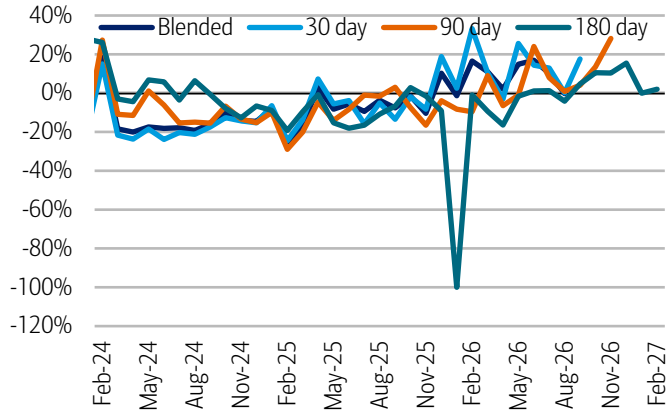
Exhibit 21: China Southern Airlines yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Yields expected to remain under YoY pressure through summer 2026a



Source: RDC

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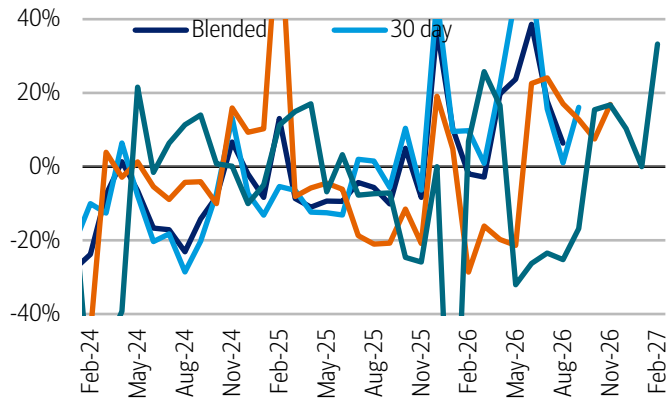
Exhibit 22: Cathay Pacific yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Early bookings show airfare at -3% to -5% YoY in the coming months



Source: RDC

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Exhibit 23: Singapore Airlines yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Early bookings show airfare decline to -17%to -32% YoY in the coming months

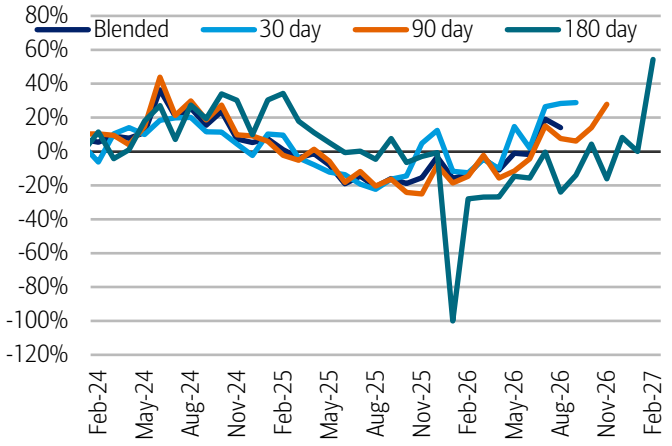


Source: RDC

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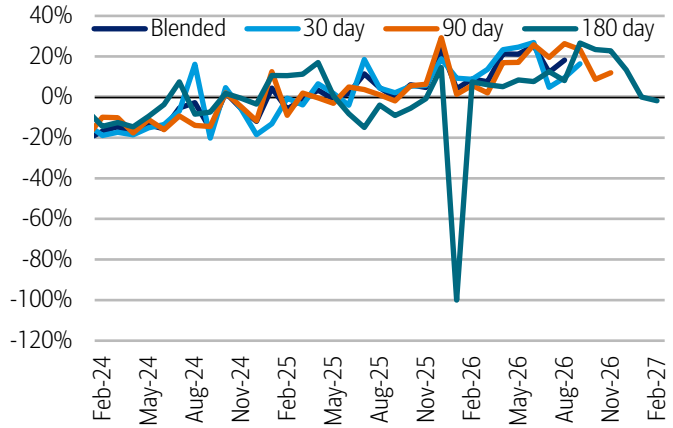
Exhibit 24: IndiGo yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Pricing trends under pressure during the summer



Source: RDC

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Exhibit 25: Qantas yields (% YoY), 2024-2027
Qantas seeing positive yield momentum into 2H26

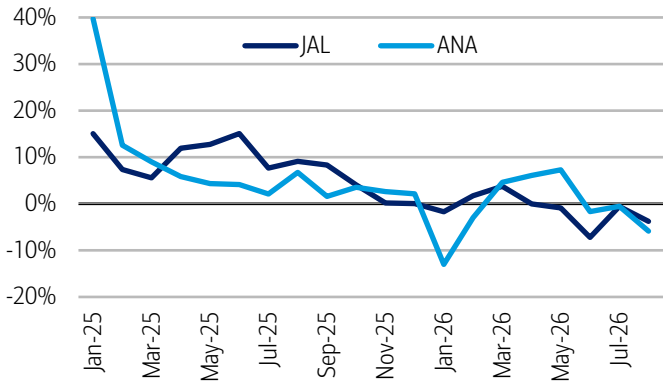


Source: RDC

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Japan travel trends

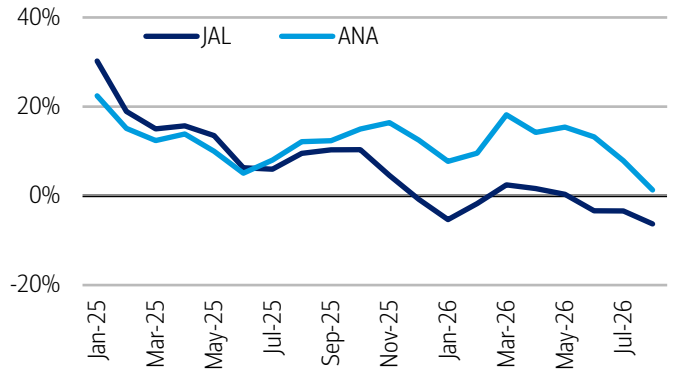
Exhibit 26: JAL vs. ANA Domestic traffic YoY growth % (2025-26)
In Aug JAL/ANA at -3.8%/-5.8% YoY



Source: Company report

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Exhibit 27: JAL vs. ANA International traffic YoY growth % (2025-26)
In Aug JAL/ANA at -6%/+1% YoY



Source: Company report

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Exhibit 28: Japan short-haul outbound by capacity (% YoY), 2026
Korea and Southeast Asia growth the most with China the lag

	Taiwan	Korea	HK	Thailand	China	Singapore	Vietnam	Philippines	Malaysia	Indonesia
Jul-26	6%	9%	6%	9%	-54%	6%	1%	1%	13%	-5%
Aug-26	4%	10%	2%	-6%	-53%	2%	1%	-1%	5%	-3%
Sep-26	5%	13%	10%	-6%	-46%	8%	2%	10%	10%	0%
Oct-26	4%	6%	3%	4%	-43%	7%	1%	0%	10%	-1%
Nov-26	-2%	0%	7%	-3%	-24%	-8%	-2%	-9%	3%	4%
Dec-26	-4%	-6%	-5%	-10%	3%	-14%	-6%	-16%	-14%	4%

Source: Diio, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 29: Japan long-haul outbound by capacity (% YoY), 2026
Japan-Middleeast capacity has some recovery

	USA	Australia	Canada	Germany	UAE	France	Türkiye	UK	Qatar
Jul-26	-2%	0%	6%	-1%	24%	5%	13%	0%	6%
Aug-26	-2%	0%	7%	-2%	21%	5%	14%	0%	4%
Sep-26	-5%	0%	1%	-2%	21%	-8%	10%	0%	3%
Oct-26	-6%	0%	-2%	0%	22%	-6%	11%	1%	4%
Nov-26	-7%	5%	-11%	13%	24%	1%	24%	12%	8%
Dec-26	-8%	1%	-12%	17%	25%	-3%	23%	12%	13%

Source: Diio, BofA Global Research

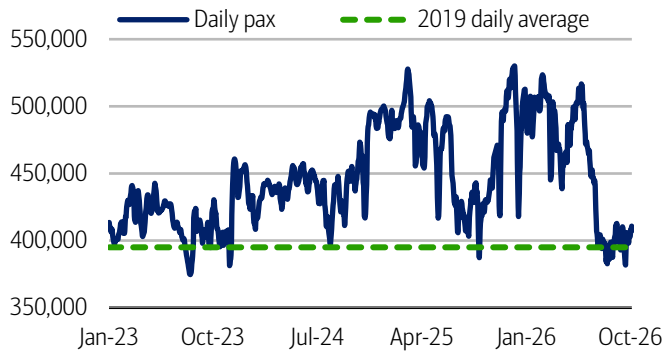
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Indian air travel trends

Indian domestic air traffic much affected by ongoing war in Middle East:

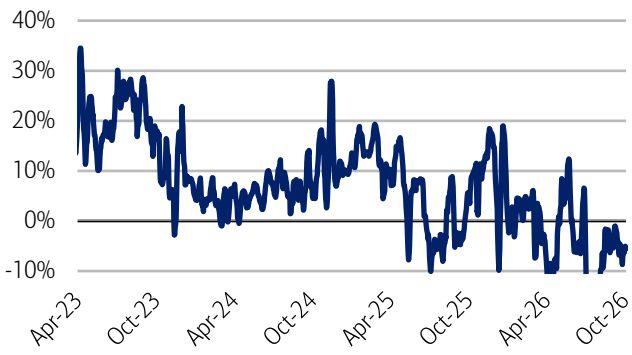
Exhibit 30: Indian domestic air passengers (# 7D MA), 2023-2026
Indian domestic air traffic much affected by ongoing war in Middle East



Source: MoCA

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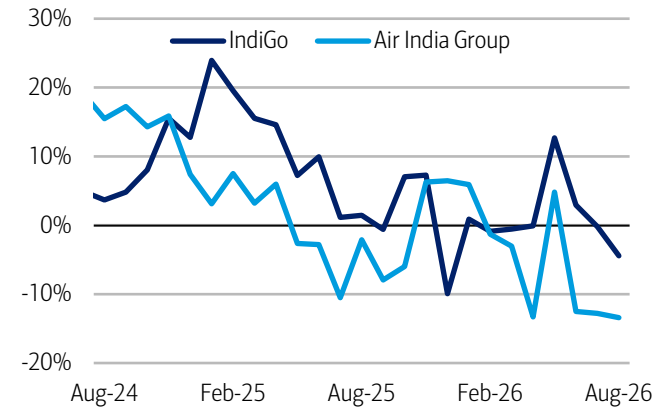
Exhibit 31: Indian domestic air passengers YoY (#7D MA), 2023-2026
Indian domestic air traffic much affected by ongoing war in Middle East



Source: MoCA

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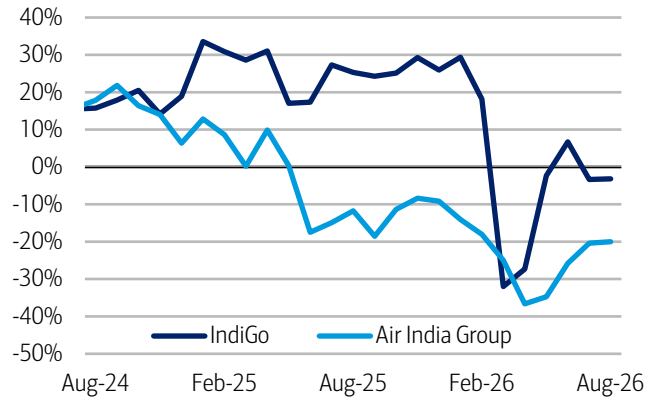
Exhibit 32: IndiGo & Air India Group domestic traffic YoY %
IndiGo/Air India Aug domestic traffic YoY growth at -4%/-13%



Source: DGCA

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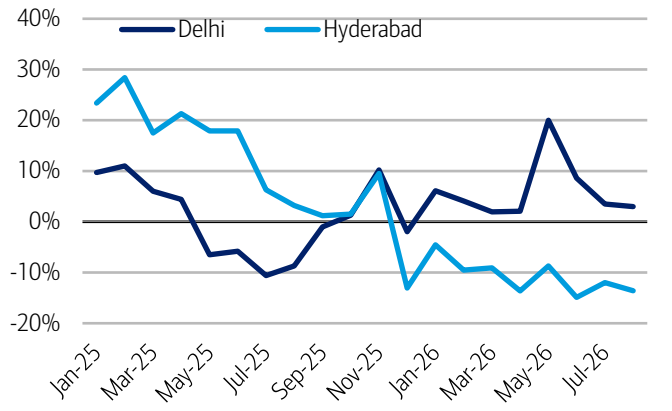
Exhibit 33: IndiGo & Air India Group International traffic YoY %
IndiGo/Air India Aug international traffic YoY growth at -3%/-20%



Source: DGCA

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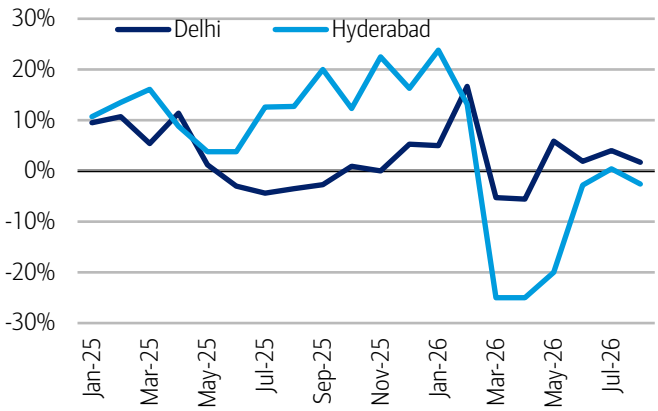
Exhibit 34: Del vs. Hyd Domestic traffic growth %YoY (2025-26)
In Aug 2026 Del/Hyd at +3%/-14% YoY



Source: GMR Airport company report

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Exhibit 35: Del vs. Hyd International traffic growth %YoY (2025-26)
In Aug 2026 Del/Hyd at +2%/-3% YoY



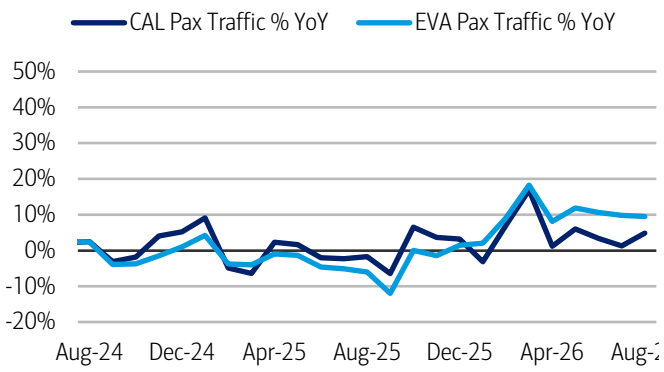
Source: GMR Airport company report

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Taiwan air travel trends

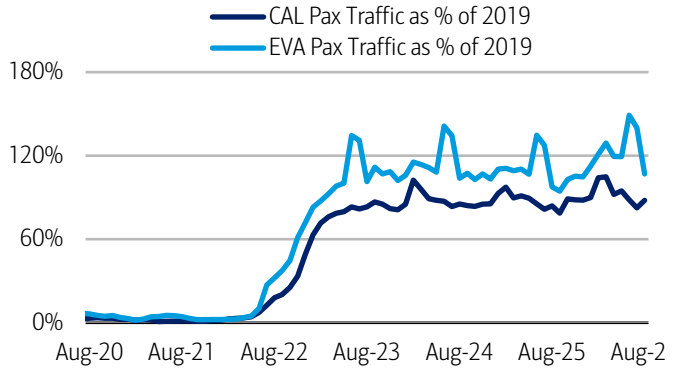
Exhibit 36: CAL & EVA - Passenger Traffic % YoY, 2026
CAL/EVA's passenger traffic +5%/+10% YoY in Aug 2026



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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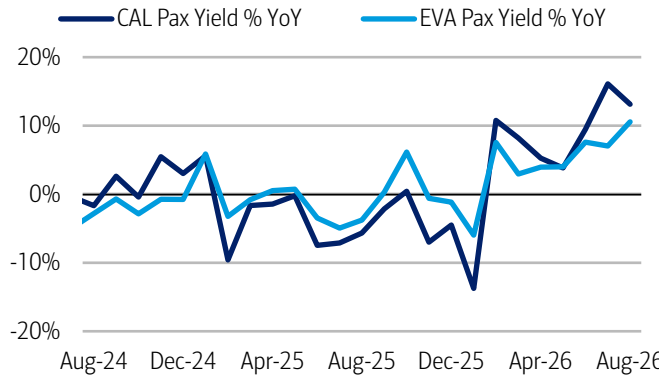
Exhibit 37: CAL & EVA - Passenger Traffic as % of 2019, 2020-2025
CAL/EVA's passenger traffic at 88%/107% of normal in Aug 2026



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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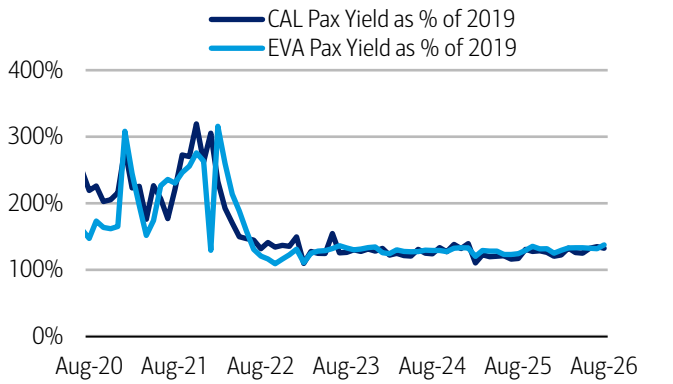
Exhibit 38: CAL & EVA - Passenger Yield % YoY, 2026
CAL/EVA's passenger yield +13%/+11% YoY in Aug 2026



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 39: CAL & EVA - Passenger Yield as % of 2019, 2020-2026
CAL/EVA's passenger yield at 132%/137% of normal in Aug 2026



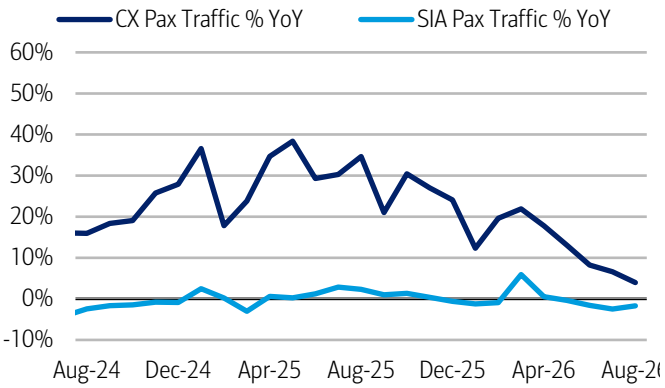
Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Long haul travel trends

CX/SIA traffic at 100%/110% of 2019 levels in Aug 2026:

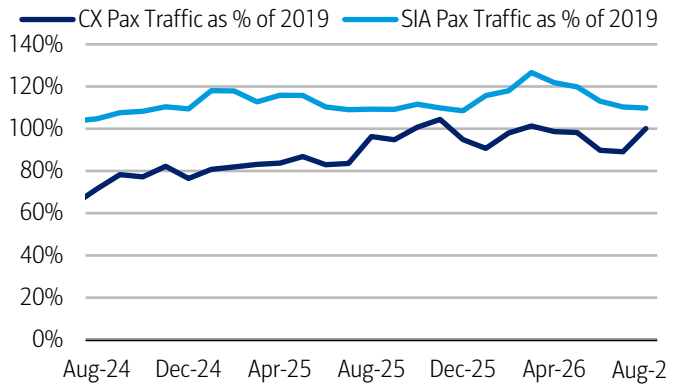
Exhibit 40: CX & SIA - Passenger Traffic % YoY, 2024-2026
CX/SIA Aug pax traffic +4%/-2% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 41: CX & SIA - Passenger Traffic as % of 2019, 2024-2026
CX/SIA Aug pax traffic at 100%/110% of normal levels



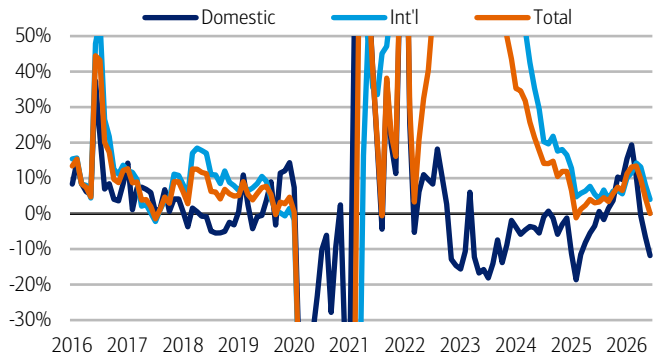
Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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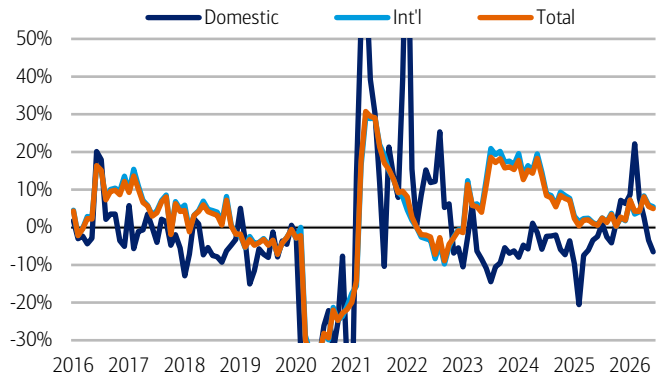
Korean air travel trends

Exhibit 42: The no. of int'l passenger growth slightly narrowed to 4% in June from 8% in May
Korea monthly domestic, int'l and total no.of passenger YoY%



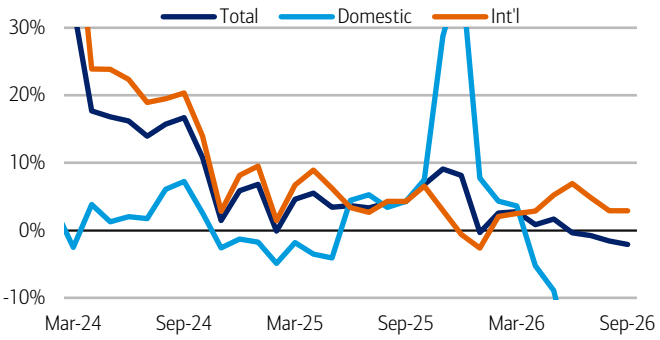
Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Exhibit 43: Int'l cargo volume increased 5% YoY in June
Korea monthly domestic, int'l and total cargo carried in ton YoY%



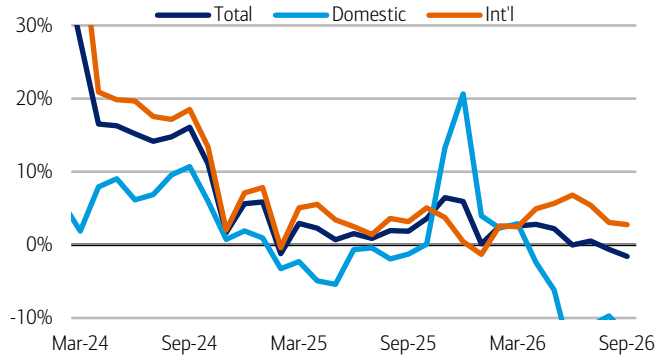
Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Exhibit 44: The domestic no. of seats offered significantly drop continued while int'l remaining expansion
Korean Air domestic, int'l and overall seats offerings YoY% in 2024-2026



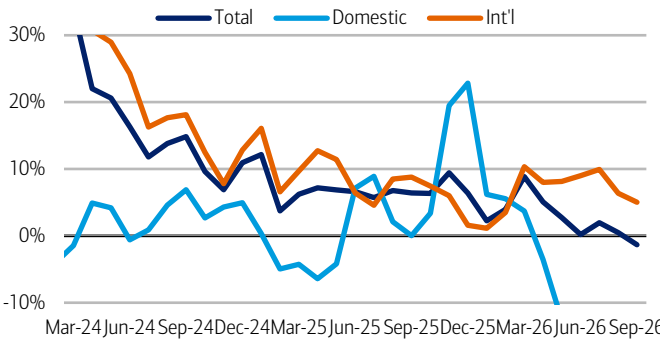
Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Exhibit 45: The domestic no. of flight offered significantly continued in Sep while int'l remaining expansion
Korean Air domestic, int'l and overall no.of flight YoY% in 2024-2026



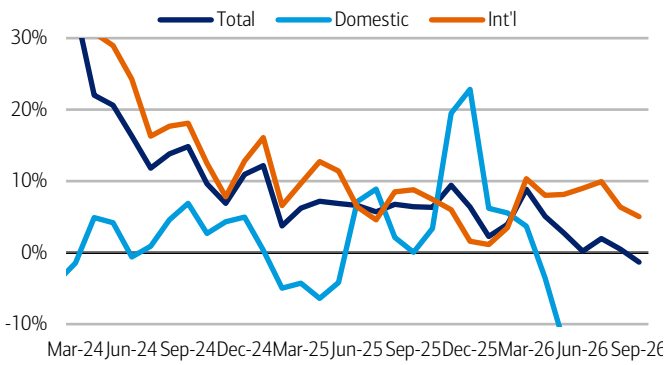
Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Exhibit 46: The int'l no. of passenger slowed down to 5% YoY for shorter Chuseok holiday in 2026
Korean Air domestic, int'l and overall no.of passenger YoY% in 2024-2026



Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Exhibit 47: The int'l no. of passenger slowed down to 5% YoY for shorter Chuseok holiday in 2026
Korean Air domestic, int'l and overall no.of passenger YoY% in 2024-2026



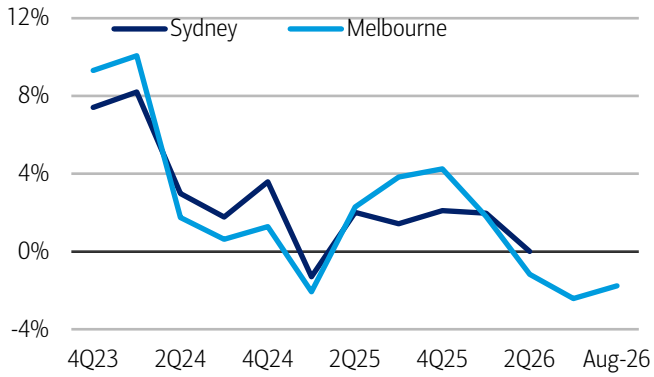
Source: Korea Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport, BofA Global Research
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Australia travel trends

MEL Domestic/International traffic at -2%/-1% YoY growth in Aug 2026.

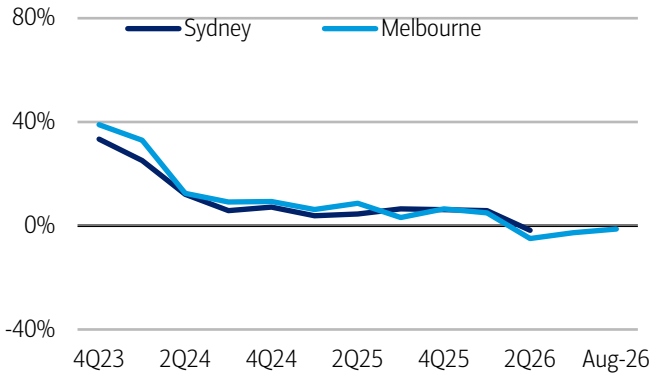
Exhibit 48: SYD & MEL airport domestic traffic (%YoY)
Domestic traffic at MEL -2% YoY in Aug



Source: Company reports

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Exhibit 49: SYD & MEL airport international traffic (%YoY)
International traffic at MEL -1% YoY in Aug

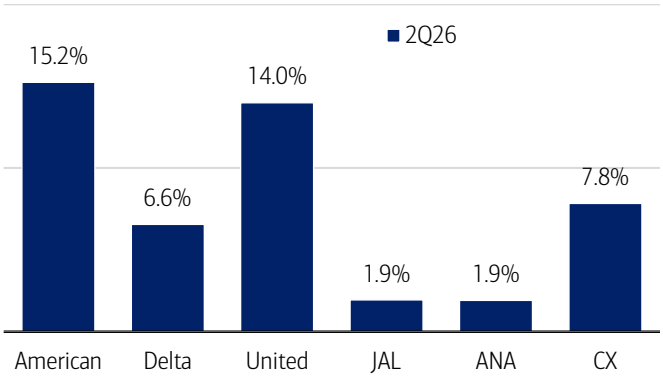


Source: Company reports

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Asia Pacific unit revenue trends

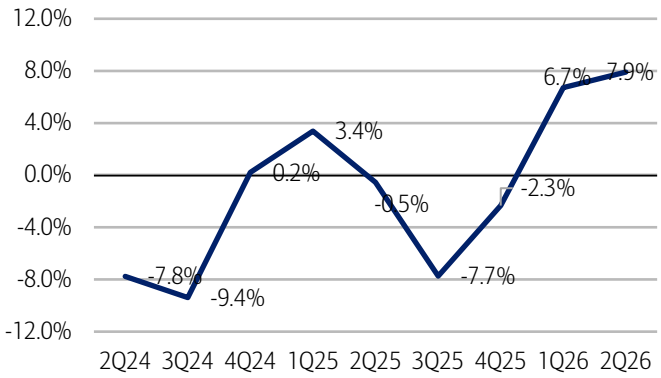
Exhibit 50: Transpacific US$ unit revenues (% YoY), 2Q26
Americal airlines 2Q26 unit revenue +15.2% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 51: Transpacific average US$ unit revenue (% YoY), 2024-26
2Q26 average revenue growth +7.9% YoY

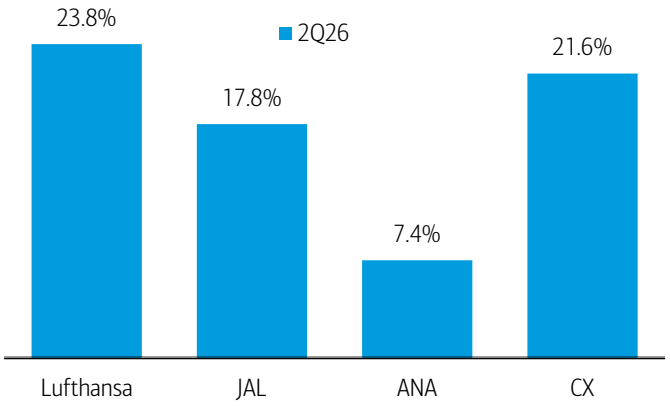


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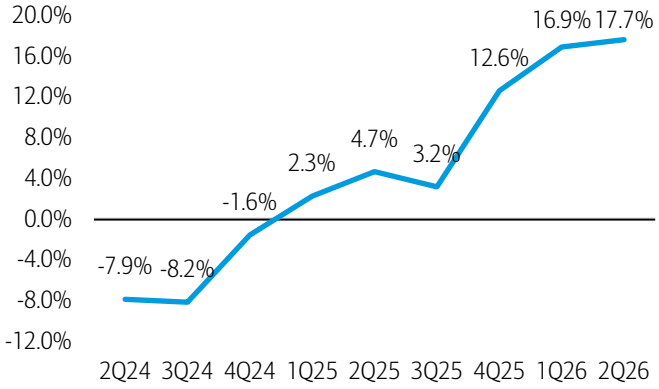
Exhibit 52: Asia-Europe US$ unit revenues (% YoY), 2Q26
Lufthansa 2Q26 unit revenue +24% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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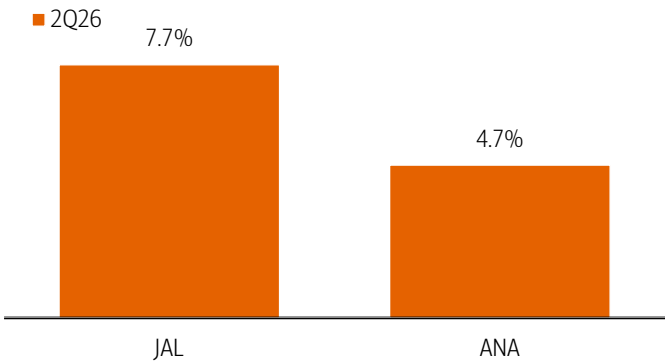
Exhibit 53: Asia-Europe average US$ unit revenue (% YoY), 2024-26
2Q26 average revenue growth +17.7% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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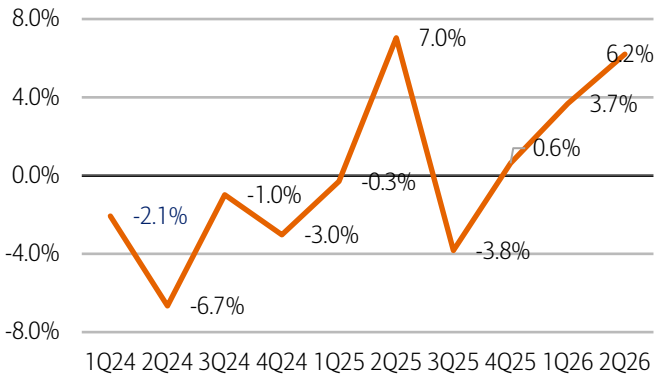
Exhibit 54: Intra-Asia US$ unit revenues (% YoY), 2Q26
JAL 2Q26 unit revenue +7.7% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 55: Intra-Asia average US$ unit revenue (% YoY), 2024-26
2Q26 average revenue growth +6.2% YoY



Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research

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Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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